

Ideation Phase

Define the Problem Statement

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Project Name	Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow

1. Background & Context

In many organizations, managing core network requests - such as VPN access, firewall rule modifications, IP address allocations, and port configurations is handled through manual emails and disconnected spreadsheets.

Without a centralized request management system, teams encounter significant operational friction. Requests are frequently lost or delayed, required technical parameters are omitted, approvals take days to secure, and network engineers waste time on administrative back-and-forth communication instead of focusing on critical infrastructure tasks.

2. Proposed Solution

To resolve these challenges, we propose implementing an automated Network Request Workflow in ServiceNow. This system provides a unified Service Catalog item with dynamic input validation, automated approval routing via Flow Designer, auto-assignment of fulfillment tasks to network teams, and real-time request status tracking.

3. Problem Statement Matrix (PS-1 to PS-6)

The table below provides a structured cause-and-effect analysis of the main obstacles faced across different roles:

ID	Stakeholder	Functional Goal	Process Breakdown	Root Cause	Negative Outcome
PS-1	Requester	Request network changes easily	Long turnaround times for simple network access	Manual email submission and manual approval routing	Reduced productivity while waiting for network access
PS-2	Network Engineer	Process network tickets efficiently	Constantly chasing requesters for missing information	No dynamic form validation to enforce mandatory fields	Increased ticket processing time and user frustration
PS-3	Security Officer	Enforce security rules on network access	Manual cross-checking of access requests takes too long	Lack of automated role-based approval workflows	Delayed approvals or accidental over-provisioning of access
PS-4	IT Manager	Monitor service delivery standards	No centralized view of open network requests and SLAs	Reliance on disconnected manual tracking methods	Inability to track service level agreements or team efficiency
PS-5	Auditor	Verify authorized network changes	Hard to trace authorization records for past changes	Approval documentation is buried in individual email accounts	Failure to meet regulatory compliance and security audit standards

ID	Stakeholder	Functional Goal	Process Breakdown	Root Cause	Negative Outcome
PS-6	System Admin	Standardize request operations	High volume of routine, repetitive admin tickets	Absence of self-service catalog items and automated task assignment	Unnecessary operational overhead and delayed system maintenance

4. Key Problems Identified

Based on our analysis, the core challenges of the current process are summarized below:

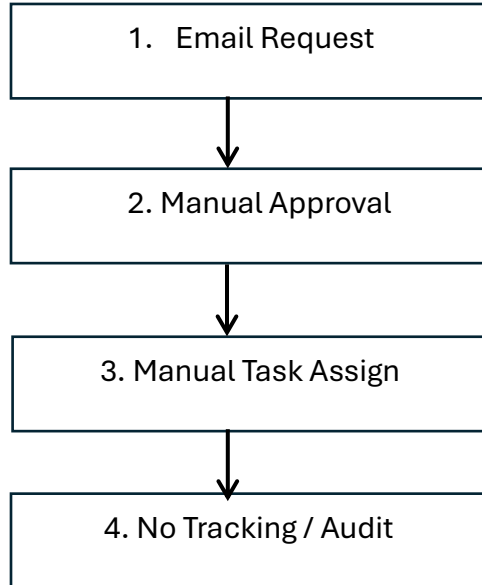
- **Absence of Central Intake:** Lack of a unified portal to submit standardized network requests.
- **Manual Processing Delays:** Email-based requests sit unread in inboxes with no automated escalation.
- **Incomplete Data Capture:** Missing IP addresses, subnets, or port details create communication backlogs.
- **Lack of Status Tracking:** Requesters cannot check request progress, leading to repeated follow-up emails.
- **Unmonitored SLAs & Audits:** Absence of dashboards and audit logs makes tracking compliance impossible.

5. Process Transformation Diagram

The diagram below compares the current manual email process with the automated ServiceNow workflow:

PROCESS COMPARISON: MANUAL VS AUTOMATED SERVICENOW WORKFLOW

Manual Workflow:



ServiceNow Workflow:

